

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Lavender, for calm and the senses

I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

Psalms 139:14

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Read “Meet the Family” – the Eden family's homestead; meet lavender's calm.
- TUESDAY** Lavender discovery – smell, look, sketch the spike
- WEDNESDAY** Brew lavender tea – measure, steep, taste
- THURSDAY** Roman baths – draw lavender by Roman arches
- FRIDAY** Root a lavender sprig; wrap up the week together

Subjects woven this week: Bible · Science ·
ELA · Math · Art · History · Geography · Latin ·
Health · Character

AROUND THE TABLE

*What helps your body feel calm
at night?*

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Dried lavender buds
- Hot water
- Mug
- Honey
- Cloth square + tie
- Clear cup + water (to root the sprig)
- Crayons or colored pencils
- Sketchbook



Lavender

Lavandula angustifolia

Read-Aloud & Discussion

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Lavender

Foundations - Calm & Senses

MONDAY ORIENTATION

This week we begin our year with a story. Read “Meet the Family” aloud together – it introduces the Eden family: Vovó and PopPop on their Tennessee homestead, Levi and Ruthie, big-hearted Manny, gentle Evie, fiery little Gracie, and Bear, the goofy dog who knocks something over every week. All year this family will learn the way we will – at the kitchen table and out in the garden, where God has already tucked everything our bodies need. Our herb this week is lavender, calm and sweet. As your child listens, notice how Vovó pays attention – to people, to plants, to the smallest things. Wonder together: what might God want to teach us this year about the wonderful bodies He made?

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you a body that needs rest, and gave lavender a calm scent to quiet it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Which of the Eden family would you most like to meet, and why?
2. Vovó calls the garden and the table “the whole school” – what will we learn there?
3. I wonder – God made every part of you on purpose; which part makes you curious?

MEMORY VERSE

I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
It will rock us off to sleep
Breathe in slow and drift away*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them smell the dried buds, then a fresh sprig, and say which is stronger. Tuck one behind an ear. Just smell and compare.

OLDER SPROUTS

Have them rub a lavender bud and a fresh sprig, then explain why drying makes the scent stronger.

TODAY'S WORD:

SENSES – the ways our body takes in the world: sight, smell, hearing, taste, and touch.

How woven –

Bible: the memory verse, Psalm 139:14, that you are wonderfully made;

Language Arts: your child meets the Eden family and learns to name them and retell who is who;

Character: attention – like Vovó, we learn to notice people and small things with care.

Lavender greets us first through the senses, with its calm, sweet smell – a gift to a body God made to know His world.

Discovery

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Foundations - Calm & Senses

DISCOVERY LESSON

Breathe in slowly, the way a naturalist would: that clean calm is lavender. Set a few dried buds in your child's palm. Look first: lavender climbs on tall, slender spikes, and every tiny flower is purple. Roll one bud between two fingers and breathe in – that soft, clean scent is its gift. Then feel the narrow, gray-green leaves, a little dry and rough, the way plants of sunny, rocky hillsides often are. Ask your child to tell back what each sense found, in their own words; there is no wrong answer, only careful looking. The same God who folded that scent into so small a flower made the very nose that breathes it in.

CORE QUESTION:

What does your nose notice first when you rub a lavender bud?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Look: find lavender's purple spikes and gray-green leaves.
2. Rub: roll one bud between two fingers.
3. Smell: breathe in slow – does your body settle?
4. Name it: lavender's scent supports calm and rest.
5. Say today's word, RELAXING – helps the body let go and rest.

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a lavender spike; label the purple flowers and stem.
Say it: *Lavandula angustifolia* – from lavare, 'to wash'.

LAVENDER CHANT

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TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

RELAXING – eases tension so the body can settle and rest.

How woven –

Science: observing scent, color, and spike shape;

Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature

Notebook;

Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;

Latin: its name, *Lavandula*.

Kitchen Lab

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Foundations - Calm & Senses

KITCHEN LAB

Today is our first Kitchen Lab, and we are making lavender tea. Grown-ups call a tea made from flowers or leaves an infusion – it just means soaking them in hot water to draw out scent and flavor. So 'infusion' and 'tea' are the same thing! We will also tie a few dried buds into a little cloth sachet. One prep, made and enjoyed today.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab: brew and taste today; we never save it. Hot water is hot – a grown-up always pours it and lets the tea cool before your child sips.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Measure 1 tsp of dried lavender buds into a mug.
2. Pour 8 oz of hot water over the buds.
3. Cover and steep 5 minutes – count them together.
4. Strain out the buds.
5. Stir in a little honey if you like; cool, then taste.
6. For the sachet: spoon dried buds onto a cloth square and tie it shut.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: A little lavender goes far! We smell and touch the dried buds, but lavender essential oil is very strong – never taste it.

LAVENDER CHANT

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Today's threads: Science • Math • Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

SACHET – a small cloth bag of dried herbs that scents the air.

How woven –

Science: hot water draws the scent and flavor out of the dried buds;

Math: measure 1 teaspoon and count 5 steep-minutes;

Health: warm tea and slow breathing help the body rest.

History & Art

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HISTORY LESSON

In ancient Rome, the public baths steamed with the fresh scent of lavender. The Romans loved to be clean, and they tucked lavender into their bathwater and even their laundry, so their skin and clothes carried its fresh, calming scent. They loved it so much that the plant's very name remembers it: 'lavender' is said to come from the Latin word lavare, which means 'to wash.' Every time we say its name, we speak a little Latin from two thousand years ago! Long before anyone could explain why a calming, cleansing plant was good for tired bodies, the gift was already growing on the sunny hillsides, waiting in the garden for the Romans.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

God made every plant on Creation's third day (Genesis 1:11-12). About 2,000 years ago the Romans pinned lavender to history, scenting their baths and laundry with it; its name is traditionally traced to lavare – 'to wash.'

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw three tall lavender stems rising up your page.
2. Climb each stem with rows of tiny purple flowers.
3. Color the slender leaves a soft gray-green.
4. Behind them, add Roman arches and columns.
5. Title it 'Lavender in Rome' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find the Mediterranean Sea and Italy on the map. Lavender loves the warm, sunny, rocky hills of this seaside land.

LAVENDER CHANT

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Today's threads: History • Geography • Art • Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

LAVARE – the Latin word for 'to wash,' the root of the name 'lavender.'

How woven –

History: the Romans and their scented baths;

Geography: finding the Mediterranean and Italy;

Art: a Roman-arch lavender drawing;

Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.

Garden & Review

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GARDEN ACTIVITY

1. With a grown-up, snip a small sprig from a lavender plant.
 2. Strip the leaves off the bottom of the stem.
 3. Stand the sprig in a clear cup of water on a sunny windowsill.
 4. Change the water every few days; watch for tiny white roots.
- This is a cutting – one little sprig can grow a whole new plant!

NEXT WEEK

Next week: chamomile – a tiny daisy flower that brings calm and grows so easily.

WEEK REVIEW

1. How does lavender's calm scent help the body God gave you?
2. You smelled, brewed, and grew lavender. Which did you like best?
3. Lavender made its scent before anyone knew why. What does that make you wonder about God?
4. One sprig grows a whole new plant. Who could you share lavender with?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Psalm 139:14

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
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Breathe in slow and drift away*

Vovó says: God gave us the scent of rest so we would remember to be still.

Today's threads: Science • Language Arts • Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

SPRIG – a small cut piece of a plant that can grow roots and become a whole new plant.

How woven –

Science: rooting a lavender sprig to watch for white roots;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Psalm 139:14 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

Grieve, A Modern Herbal (1931),
'Lavenders' • POWO,
Lavandula angustifolia (Kew) • NCCIH,
Lavender • NASB Psalm 139:13–14

FURTHER READING

Roots, Shoots, Buckets & Boots – Sharon Lovejoy (family read)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

ELA•R2 – discuss a read-aloud, learn 5 new words

Science•R2 – observe with the five senses

Geography•R2 – locate the Mediterranean & Rome

Art•R3 – botanical sketch

Math•R3 – measure 1 tsp, time a steep